What We Now Believe About Fintech

When we look back at the bootcamp, the biggest change was how we started to see fintech.

At first, we thought of it as just a set of new tools, but now we see it as a much deeper change in how financial systems work.

In the beginning, we saw fintech as a way to make financial services quicker, cheaper, and more digital. But after learning about things like

- embedded finance,
- stablecoins, and
- Working on the KBC tokenization project, we noticed a bigger shift.

Finance is now becoming part of larger digital systems, not just its own separate industry.

Financial services are now built into the platforms people already use every day. Banking is no longer something you go out of your way to do; it happens quietly as part of your experience. Because of this, banks are changing. Instead of owning the entire customer relationship, they are increasingly acting more like infrastructure providers, while platforms and AI-powered interfaces handle most of the direct user contact.

We also started to see blockchain and tokenisation in a more balanced way. At first, it looked like these technologies would remove the need for middlemen. But after the KBC tokenisation lab, we saw that banks and similar institutions are still important, and in some ways, even more so. They offer trust, make sure rules are followed, and help manage assets. So, the future of finance will likely be a mix of new technology and existing institutions, not just fully decentralised systems.

Another important insight is that fintech innovation cannot be. We also learned that you can't separate fintech innovation from regulation. During the bootcamp, especially in the sessions with legal experts and startup founders, we saw that regulation isn't just something that gets in the way. Instead, it helps shape what is possible. Rules like PSD and new European regulations set the limits and speed for new ideas. This means there is always a balance between trying new things and following the rules, and the best companies manage to do both. No single actor can build the future of finance alone. Instead, value is created through collaboration between banks, fintech startups, BigTech companies, regulators, and other stakeholders. Each of these players controls a different part of the value chain, and understanding these interdependencies is crucial for any viable business model.

One of the biggest surprises was that the hardest problems in fintech are often not about technology or strategy, but about how organizations work. The business simulation and group talks showed us that even with good ideas and plans, things can fall apart if people inside the company are not on the same page. Changing financial services is just as much about people, company structure, and motivation as it is about new technology.

In the end, we see fintech as more than just a set of trends. It's a big change toward financial services that are built into other systems, can be programmed, and rely on many different players working together. Still, trust, rules, and the roles of institutions are just as important.

The main challenge now is not just coming up with new ideas, but making sure they work in the real world.